PEER REVIEW HISTORY

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ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	The effectiveness and safety of bee venom pharmacopuncture for rheumatoid arthritis: a systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Sung, Won-Suk; Kim, Jung Hyun; Lee, Dong Hyuk; Kim, Eun-jung; Seo, Byung-Kwan; Hong, Seung-Ug; Baek, Yong; Lee, Kwang Ho; Kim, Joo-Hee

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Çelik, İlhami Selçuk University, Histology and Embryology
REVIEW RETURNED	05-Dec-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	The typographical errors marked in yellow in the text should be corrected.

REVIEWER	Kung, Yen-Ying Taipei Veterans General Hospital
REVIEW RETURNED	10-Dec-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	1. In the section of data synthesis and analysis, please state that A fixed-effects model or A random-effects model will be used in what level of heterogeneity in your meta-analysis. 2. PRISMA has a renew statement since 2020, and upgrade a new flow diagram. The authors are better to consider to use the new version.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

-Reviewer 1

1. The typographical errors marked in yellow in the text should be corrected.

-> Thank you for your valuable corrections. We corrected the errors you, as well as other spacing or capitalization problems.

-Reviewer 2

1. In the section of data synthesis and analysis, please state that A fixed-effects model or A random-effects model will be used in what level of heterogeneity in your meta-analysis.

-> Thank you for your valuable suggestion. We wrote the following sentence in the [Data synthesis and analysis] section.

-> We will use Review Manager software (Version 5.3; Copenhagen; The Nordic Cochrane Center, The Cochrane Collaboration, 2014) for the meta-analysis. The changes from the baseline to the completion of the intervention will be used and the mean difference and 95% confidence intervals (CIs) in same outcome measures, and the standardized mean difference and 95% CI in different outcome measures will be calculated to estimate the effect. In the data analysis, a random-effects model will be based because the included studies may come from different population.~ in the [Data synthesis and analysis]

2. PRISMA has a renew statement since 2020, and upgrade a new flow diagram. The authors are better to consider to use the new version.

-> We appreciate your information. We changed the PRISMA flow diagram according to the 2020 version and submitted it as figure 1.